



Get free local bookings from Google

Your Google Business Profile — set-up & optimisation checklist

When someone in Carlisle searches “**acne treatment near me**” or “**skin clinic Carlisle**”, Google shows a map with 3 clinics at the top. Those 3 get the bookings — **for free**, before anyone scrolls down. This guide gets The Skin Den into that top 3. It's the cheapest bookings you'll ever get: no ad budget, no commission. Work through it once, then spend 5 minutes a week keeping it active.

1 Claim & verify your profile

- Go to **google.com/business** and sign in with the Skin Den Google account.
- Search for **The Skin Den** — if a profile already exists, claim it; if not, create it.
- Google verifies by **video, phone or postcard**. Do this first — nothing shows publicly until you're verified.

2 Fill in every single field

Google ranks complete profiles above half-finished ones. Leave nothing blank.

- **Business name:** The Skin Den — *exactly as it's known, no keyword stuffing (against Google's rules)*
- **Phone:** 07568 602 861 (your WhatsApp booking line)
- **Website:** add your site here once it's live (e.g. theskinden.co.uk)
- **Address / service area:** set your Carlisle clinic address (or mark it a **service-area / private studio** if you'd rather keep the address off the map), then add a service area of Carlisle & surrounding Cumbria.
- **Hours:** set your **real opening hours** accurately — Google flags “open now”, and wrong hours lose bookings.
- **Booking link:** add your booking system or WhatsApp link in the “**Bookings**” field so clients can book straight from Google.

3 Pick the right categories

- **Primary category:** Skin care clinic
- **Secondary categories:** Facial spa Aesthetician

The primary category is one of the biggest ranking factors — get it exactly right. As an acne specialist, “Skin care clinic” pulls the right enquiries.

4 Add real photos (this matters more than people think)

- Upload **15–20 real photos** — the treatment room, products, results (with client permission), and you at work.
- **Before/after skin journeys** are powerful — get written consent and share the wins.
- Add your **logo** and a **cover photo**, plus a few fresh photos every week or two — active profiles rank higher.

Skin clients book on trust and results. Real before/after photos and a calm, clean clinic do more than any words can.

5 Write a keyword-rich description & services

- In the **description**, naturally mention: *advanced facials, acne treatment programmes, problem-skin specialist, skin consultations, chemical peels, dermaplaning, skin needling, Carlisle & Cumbria*.
- Add each treatment as a separate **Service** with a short sentence and price — they show on your profile and help you appear for those searches.
- Mention any **qualifications / accreditations** — for skin treatments, credentials build serious trust.

6 Reviews — the #1 ranking factor

More reviews = higher ranking *and* more bookings. Make asking part of every appointment.

How to do it the easy way

- In your profile, copy your “**review link**” (Google gives you a short link).
- Message it to the client after their treatment, while they're feeling great about their skin.
- **Reply to every review** — even a one-line thank-you. Google rewards it.

Copy-paste message to send clients:

“Thank you for coming in today — it was lovely to see you and your skin is looking fab! ✨ If you've got 30 seconds, a quick Google review really helps my little clinic. Here's the link: [your review link]. See you next time! Rachel x”

Target: aim for your first **10 reviews** fast, then a steady trickle. Even 15–20 strong reviews puts you ahead of most local skin clinics.

7 Post updates (like a free mini-Instagram)

- Use **Google Posts** to share a skin tip, a new treatment, a seasonal offer, or a recently-freed appointment slot.
- One post a week keeps the profile active — Google favours active profiles.

8 Turn on messaging & answer questions

- Enable **messaging** so clients can message you straight from Google (or point it to your WhatsApp).
- Seed the **Q&A** section yourself: “Do you treat acne?” → “Yes — acne and problem skin is my specialty. Book a consultation and we'll build a plan for your skin.”

Your 5-minute weekly routine

- **Ask** every client that week for a Google review (send the message).
- **Reply** to any new reviews.
- **Add** 1–2 fresh photos (treatment, product, or a consented before/after).
- **Post** one update (a skin tip, an offer, or an open slot).
- **Check** your “insights” — how many people called, messaged or asked directions.

Do this and within a few weeks you'll be getting bookings from Google you didn't pay a penny for — on top of your website and Instagram.